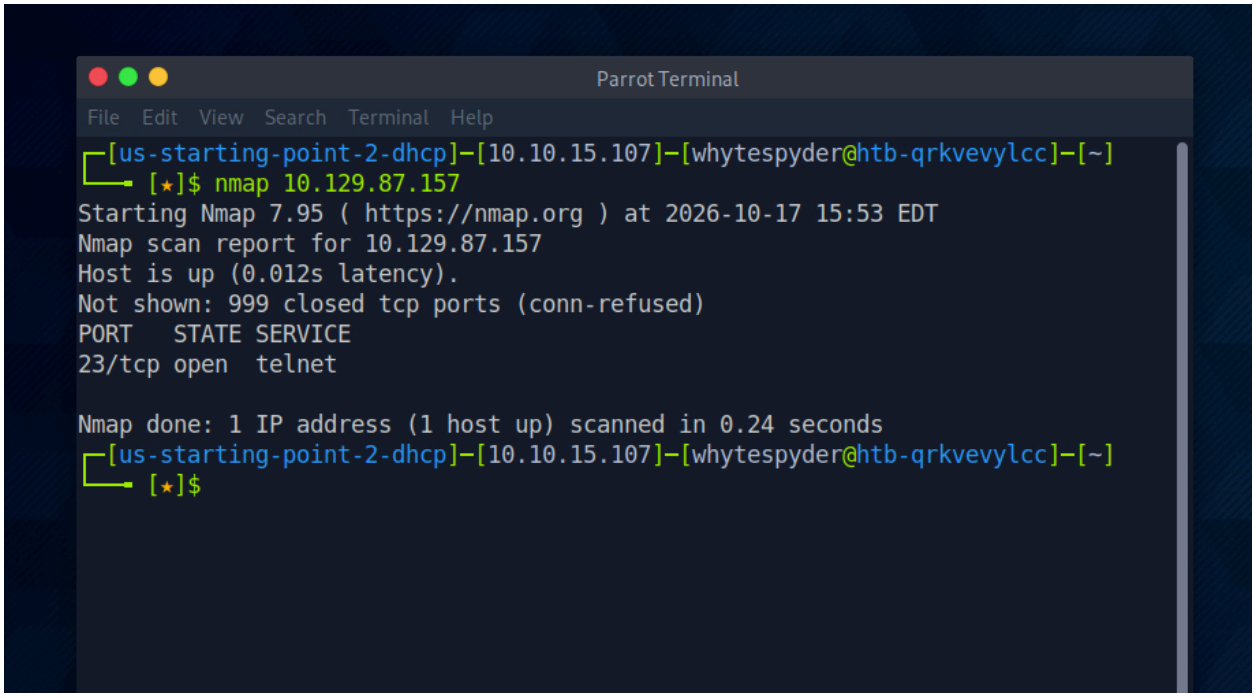
Writeup for Meow Machine on HackTheBox (10/17/2026)

Target IP: 10.129.87.157

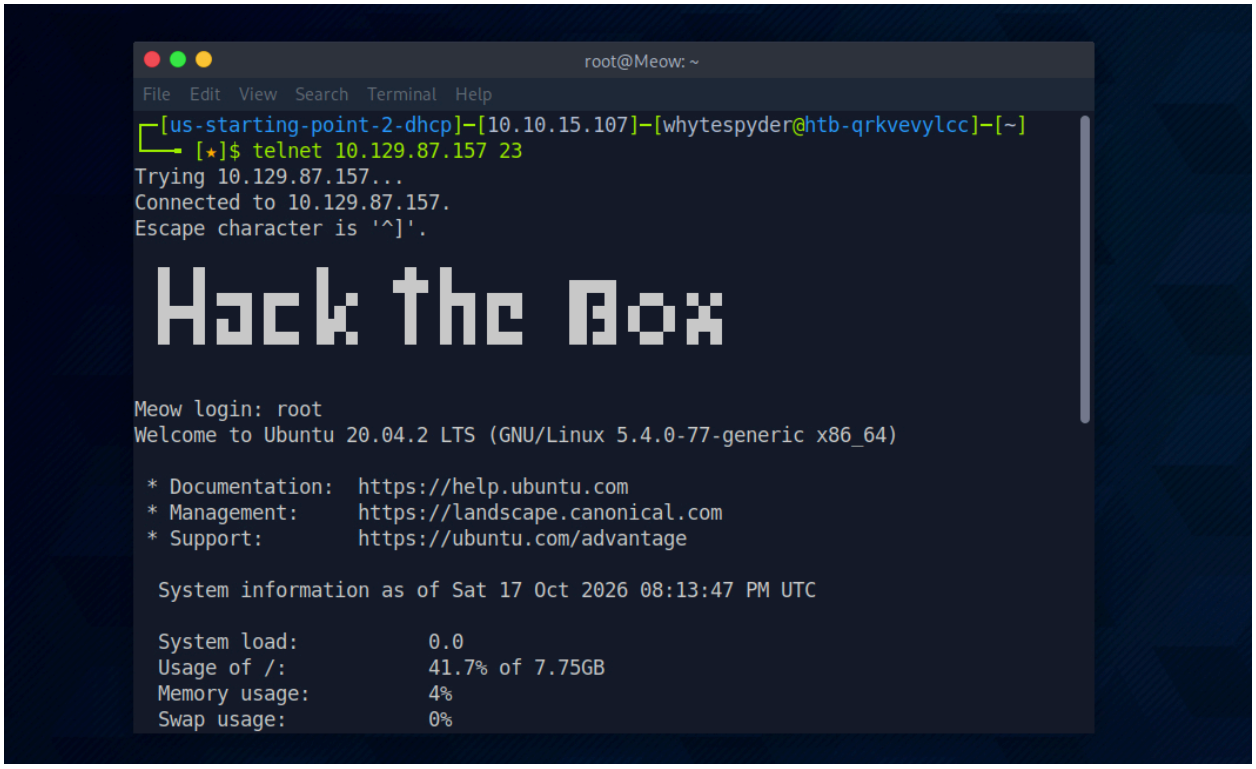
The first thing that we do is Enumeration.

nmap scan results:
Starting Nmap 7.95 (https://nmap.org) at 2026-10-17 15:53 EDT
Nmap scan report for 10.129.87.157
Host is up (0.012s latency).
Not shown: 999 closed tcp ports (conn-refused)
PORT STATE SERVICE
23/tcp open telnet



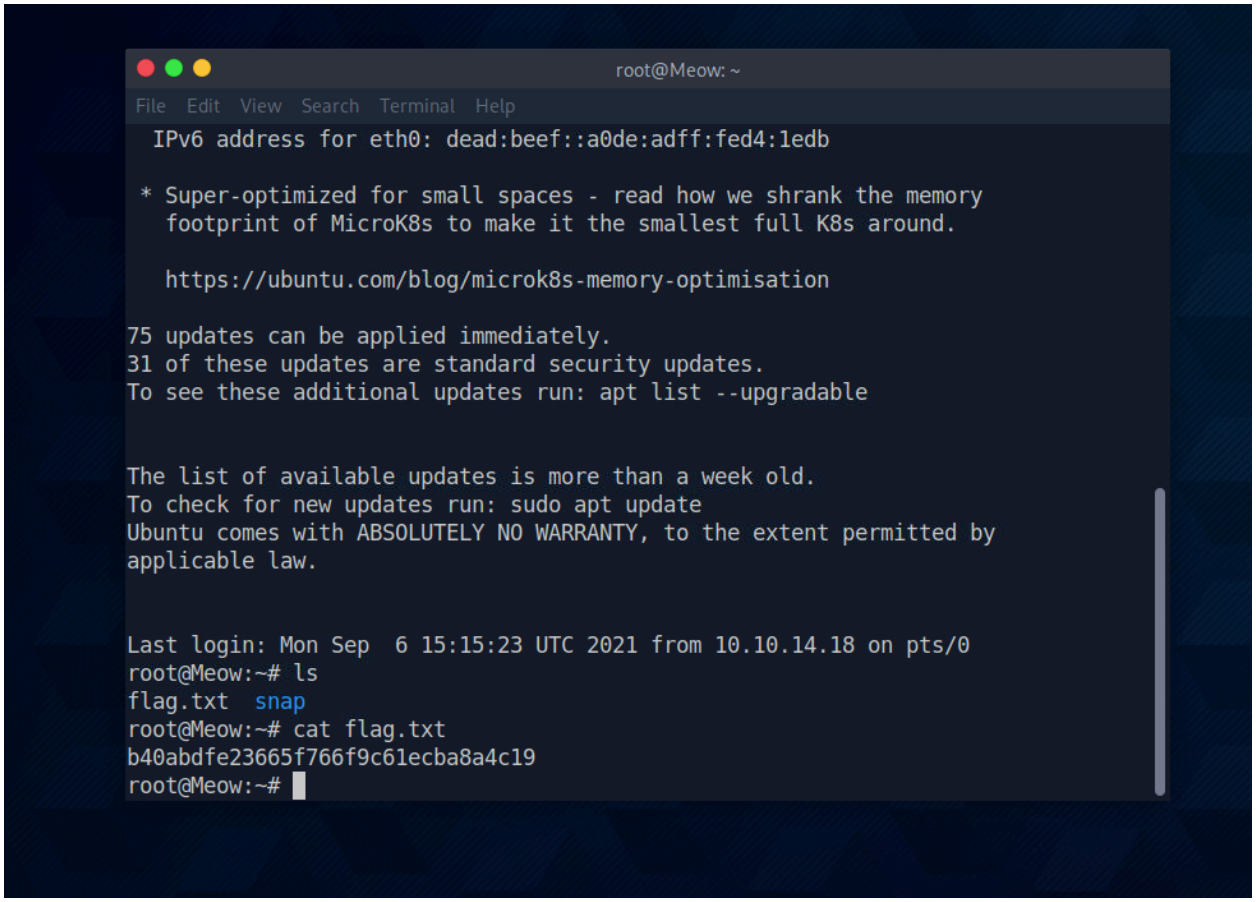
We can see that on port 23, telnet is running.
Telnet is a protocol used to issue remote commands.
It would be incredible if we could get access to tellnet.
We know that root is often a username that is used on telnet as default/no login.

Let's try it!



We were able to get root with no password by logging in via telnet.

From there we just go to the home directory and display the contents of the flag.txt folder.



There is the flag!
Flag: b40abdfe23665f766f9c61ecba8a4c19